

FAYANA RICHARDS, PhD, MPH

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SUMMARY

Program operations and project management leader with 18+ years of experience supporting research, academic, nonprofit, and public health initiatives across complex, multi-partner environments. Experienced in grant and project management, scope of work development, budget monitoring, milestone tracking, stakeholder communication, and program process improvement. Works closely with faculty, community partners, clients, and cross-functional teams to keep projects organized, documented, and on schedule. Trained facilitator and published author and disseminated results through technical reports, quarterly briefs, journal articles and presentations at regional and global conferences.

SKILLS

Program Operations: project coordination, deliverables management, milestone and deadline tracking, budget and logistics support

Reporting and Documentation: progress summaries, final reports, documentation management, scope of work support

Cross-Functional Coordination: stakeholder communication, meeting coordination, action item follow up, research and faculty collaboration

Software: SharePoint, Microsoft Suite, Zoom, Trello, RedCap

EXPERIENCE

Senior Public Health Consultant

Michigan Public Health Institute | 2021–2025

Program and Project Management

- Coordinated 6 concurrent projects and workstreams, aligning timelines, deliverables, and stakeholder communication with organizational and client priorities.
- Led weekly team meetings and individual check-ins for project teams of 4 to 9 members, prepared agendas, directed action-item follow-up, reviewed milestones, addressed barriers, and assigned responsibilities using Microsoft Teams and Zoom.
- Scheduled biweekly meetings with collaborative partners, maintained meeting agendas and project documents in SharePoint, and supported team communication through Microsoft Teams.
- Managed production of deliverables including toolkits, concept papers, a statewide strategic plan, workshop series, and facilitation guides for grant agencies, public health professionals, older adults living with disabilities, older adults living with dementia and their caregivers, and government officials.
- Submitted quarterly progress summaries and final reports to funding agencies, collaborative partners, and clients.
- Co-monitored budgets with the Senior Financial Analyst, tracked deadlines, coordinated logistics, and maintained project approval documentation with research and evaluation staff.

- Oversaw development and monitoring of scopes of work, tracked milestones and delivery timelines, and supported contracts and joint venture agreements through issue identification and follow up.
- Reviewed work produced by Research Scientists and Research and Evaluation Associates and provided direction and expectations to support project deliverables, including toolkits, concept papers, a statewide strategic plan, workshop series, and facilitation guides.

Supervision, Facilitation and Grantsmanship

- Supervised and mentored 2 staff members, supporting skill development and alignment to program objectives.
- Designed and facilitated more than 50 workshops for public health professionals and clients, supporting project execution.
- Co-wrote 5 concept papers with collaborative partners for grant opportunities.

Assistant Professor of Medical Anthropology

University of Memphis | 2019–2021

Curriculum Design and Instruction

- Designed and taught 6 undergraduate and graduate courses and developed Learning Management System materials and interactive learning activities aligned with course objectives using instructional design principles.
- Graded student papers, developed in-class surveys to assess comprehension and satisfaction, and revised course content based on student feedback.

Program Support and Supervision

- Contributed to department administrative planning and curriculum review through committee service and related program support activities.
- Supervised 6 undergraduate and graduate student practicum placements, strengthening student's applied research and implementation skills.

Research and Grant Activities

- Published peer-reviewed work on grandparent caregiving and the social and cultural impact of caregiving on aging and presented at national and international conferences.
- Secured funding for research project on caregiving and social isolation in Memphis, TN and Detroit, MI.

Visiting Assistant Professor of Public Health

Hampshire College | 2019

Curriculum Design, Instruction and Supervision

- Developed instructional material for 2 undergraduate courses using adult learning principles aligned with student needs and institutional mission.
- Delivered interactive lectures integrating evidence based public health concepts, including research design, evaluation, and data interpretation.
- Oversaw thesis development for 3 undergraduate students, fostering skill development and mentoring students through end-to-end project development.

Post-Doctoral Research Associate

University of Massachusetts, Amherst | 2018

Grant Submission and Project Development

- Supported NIH R01 proposal development by drafting, editing, and conducting compliance reviews of grant requirements and budget preparation.
- Coordinated input across faculty and administrative stakeholders to ensure the timely, accurate, and compliant submission of a competitive funding proposal.
- Designed and implemented a professional development curriculum for underrepresented students, expanding access to research training and institutional support.

Community Engagement and Research Activities

- Collaborated with a Community Research Liaison and Project Manager to strengthen the membership of Center for Community Health Research's Community Steering Board by building relationships with local organizations and nonprofit professionals and attending community meetings.
- Conducted targeted literature reviews to support Principal Investigator requests.
- Analyzed dissertation data and presented findings at the annual American Anthropological Association meeting.

Graduate Teaching Assistant

Michigan State University | 2011-2017

Instructional Evaluation and Student Success

- Graded student papers and assignments, providing timely feedback that reinforced learning outcomes and supported faculty instruction.
- Hosted weekly meetings with students to clarify course material, improving academic performance and knowledge attainment through individualized support.
- Delivered guest lectures to undergraduate students, deepening student understanding of course concepts while refining instructional delivery skills.
- Developed assessment items that aligned with course objectives, strengthening knowledge acquisition and ensuring consistency in student evaluation.

Project Coordinator

University of Arizona | 2009–2010

Project Management and Data Collection & Analysis

- Supported biweekly budget reviews with the Principal Investigator in Excel and coordinated with the Business Office Manager as requested.
- Conducted qualitative and quantitative data transcription, and analysis using MAXQDA and SAS and maintained journal article entries in EndNote.
- Supervised and collaborated with undergraduate research assistants on research design, analysis, and presentation development.
- Presented research findings at national conferences.

EDUCATION

PhD, Medical Anthropology - Michigan State University, 2018

MPH, Public Health - Michigan State University, 2015

MA, Medical Anthropology - Michigan State University, 2012

BA, Medical Anthropology and Journalism - University of Arizona, 2008

SELECT CERTIFICATIONS AND TRAINING

Project Management Professional (PMP), Project Management Institute, 2026
Technology of Participation Strategic Planning - Institute of Cultural Affairs, 2021
Technology of Participation Facilitation Methods - Institute of Cultural Affairs, 2021
NSF Summer Institute for Research Design in Cultural Anthropology - University of Florida, 2012

SELECT FUNDING AND AWARDS

NSF Graduate Research Fellowship Program - National Science Foundation, 2011-2014
NSF Alliance for Graduate Education and the Professoriate Award - Michigan State University, 2011-2013
National Cancer Institute Diversity Research Supplement - National Institutes of Health, 2009

SELECT AFILIATIONS

Affiliate Faculty, Center for Community Health Research - University of Massachusetts, Amherst, 2019 – Present